

Correctly Use and Reference ChatGPT in Academic Writing

Video Transcript

What's up guys. Welcome back to the smart student. My name is Chelsea Seaborn.

Today, we're going to talk about how you can use artificial intelligence in your academic writing. Specifically, we're going to focus on chat GPT. Now, the reason is because APA formatting has officially released a set of guidelines and rules for using programs like chat GPT in your writing, as well as how to cite and reference them correctly.

Now, before you get too excited, this does not mean you have the green light to use chat GPT to write your entire paper. It simply means that it can be used to facilitate research and even create some texts within reason. Now, of course, if your professor says anything that varies from this video, such as don't use it at all, do follow their instructions first.

Okay. So the first thing we need to talk about is how you're going to include the material in your paper. As I just said, you're not using chat GPT to write large sections of your paper.

However, you're going to treat it like any other source where if you want to use material generated by chat GPT, you need to create a new citation for those ideas that are not yours. The difference is that you're going to include the prompt that you used and the exact text that was generated. This is very important because chat GPT is designed to give you a different response.

Even if asking the same question twice to demonstrate this, here's an example from the APA blog. It reads when prompted with is the left brain, right brain divide real or a metaphor. The chat GPT generated texts indicated that although the two brain hemispheres are somewhat specialized, the notion that people can be characterized as left brain or right brain is considered to be an oversimplification oversimplification and a popular myth.

Now there's a couple of things I want to point out here. First notice how the insert is relatively small. It's not a giant wall of text taking up most of our paper.

It really is just a short sentence to help drive our point home. Next note, how it includes the prompt and the exact response word for word verbatim. Matter of fact, it's structured like a direct quote because that's exactly what you're doing is including the direct material that was used in chat GPT.

Now before we jump into how to cite and reference this, I do want to talk quickly about what to do if you, if it is appropriate to include a longer response from chat GPT. In this case, what you would do is you would include the full text within the appendix of your paper, or if you're including any supplemental material. The example that APA has on their blog would read like this.

When given a follow-up prompt of what is a more accurate representation, the chat GPT generated texts indicated that different brain regions work together to support various cognitive processes and the functional specialization of different regions can change in response to experience and environmental factors. Note how in the in-text citation, it says see appendix A for the full transcript. That is where you would include the full transcript if it was necessary for the research done on this paper.

I will note that most of you watching this video, this is not relevant. This becomes relevant when you're writing a long manuscript or perhaps a paper up for publication. But now that we know how to include the text within your paper, let's talk about how to create that reference list entry and in-text citation.

So just like any other APA reference, it's going to include four elements. You have the author, the date, the title, and the source. Then when it comes to the in-text citation, this is a shortened version of the reference list entry, which is going to only contain the author and the date.

The biggest difference when citing AI software is that it doesn't fall under a retrievable source, which is your traditional sources such as books, journal articles, web pages, nor does it fall under a personal communication. Things like emails, professors, lectures, PowerPoint slides, things like that. It falls into its own category, which APA is labeling an algorithm's output.

What that means in simple terms is that instead of looking for an author, someone who wrote the transcript, you're simply going to list the company that built the AI program. So here is an actual template you can apply to any AI software. As you can see, we have the four elements for the author.

You're going to list the company for the date. You only need the year of the model for the title. You want to include the name of the AI.

Notice that it's italicized. Then you want to include the version in parentheses. And finally, in square brackets, you want to include a descriptor.

This is simply a short description of the type of source you're citing, because again, this is a non-traditional source. So in this case, since this is a language model, I would include a large language model, simple. And then to close out the reference, you want to include the source, which in most cases, it's going to be a live URL link.

Underneath the reference template, you can see we have the template for our citations. There's two of them, because depending on how you're formatting it in your paper, it can either be a parenthetical citation or a narrative. But let's go ahead and take a look at this example with all of the elements filled in.

Here we go. We have the company, which in this case is OpenAI, followed by a period to close out the author element. The year of this model is 2023, enclosed in parentheses.

Again, a period to close out the date element. The title, we have ChatGPT in italicized formatting. And then in parentheses, we have March 14th as the version.

As you can see in the square brackets, we have the large language model as our short descriptor. Period to close out the title element. And then the source element, we have the live URL link.

To finish out the full reference, you have the corresponding in-text citation. As you can see, that includes OpenAI, 2023 for the author in date element. This will link it back to the full reference list entry at the end of your paper.

So this is a software you're citing provided it's been approved to be used in academic writing. I will say if you're using an image generator, there is a slight variation on how APA would like you to create the in-text citation in reference list entry. If that's something you need help with, be sure to check out the next video.